

Wireshark

- GUI (graphical user interface)
- High resource usage
- Allows for far more control over dissecting and analyzing packets
- Uses an advanced hierarchy of protocols
- Used primarily for complex analysis of packets/protocols
- Can decrypt traffic payloads if using the proper keys

Similarities

- Packet Capture and Analysis
- Open source software
- Rely on the same underlying libraries
- Cross-platform

tcpdump

- CLI (command line interface)
- Minimal resource usage
- Captures raw traffic in real time
- Displays hex/ascii contents of packets
- Used primarily for capturing packets for later use/analysis
- Cannot decrypt traffic payloads